A Date Which Will Live in Infamy

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · December 8, 1941

Source: Franklin D. Roosevelt, "Day of Infamy" Address (1941). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> The day after Pearl Harbor, Roosevelt asked Congress to declare war on Japan, framing the surprise attack as an act of treachery that united the nation behind entry into World War II.

Yesterday, December 7, 1941 — a date which will live in infamy — the United States of America was suddenly and deliberately attacked by naval and air forces of the Empire of Japan. The United States was at peace with that Nation and, at the solicitation of Japan, was still in conversation with its Government and its Emperor looking toward the maintenance of peace in the Pacific.

[. . .]

No matter how long it may take us to overcome this premeditated invasion, the American people in their righteous might will win through to absolute victory. . . . I ask that the Congress declare that since the unprovoked and dastardly attack by Japan on Sunday, December seventh, a state of war has existed between the United States and the Japanese Empire.